My Quarto Document

Author argues that imaginative resistance occurs when epistemic norms of consistency come into conflict with an author's prescriptions. Brian Weatherson gives an example recalling a famous highway scene.

A couple is seen fighting on the side of a busy freeway causing traffic to pile up. A passing motorist shoots them dead. The audience is instructed to accept this form of violence as justified, but instead, we are supposed to be repulsed.

However, if we consider other examples such as Pulp Fiction, Grand Theft Auto, Fargo among others, the violence is absurd and that's the point. This seems to be one of those instances. It may just be that the resistance depends on the choice of the audience.

They may choose to be repulsed, or choose to imagine that the shooting is justified. If so, then there isn't a similar imaginative resistance because the absurdity is the point.

There are first two possible reasons for this:

1. Inability to imagine impossibilities
2. Unwillingness to imagine impossibilities

We might take the one over the other.

A key qualifier of this claim is that the divergence occurs when we realize that we've mistaken some concept employed by the author of a fiction. As such, the imaginative resistance comes from an inability to imagine impossibilities. Perhaps this is similar to trying to imagine a chilliongon. After the 100th side, we just give up.

Accordingly then, there is some fact that we are to imagine but are unable to.

So while this does seem to be a problem with epistemic and not non-epistemic norms as the author points out, it is hard to see how the norm that was violated was a truth norm.

> I-belief is used to keep track of information about events, characters and their motivations, and other fictional details that the author supplies us with (Friend, 2017).

However imaginative resistance is a series of cases where i-Beliefs do not constrain our imaginative capacities since perhaps there is no normative direction of fit. But surely there must be intent on the part of either party, the audience or author. For instance, John Gilmore (2020) has argued that artists can sometimes fail to achieve the function which they intended.

But we might add, they do not contextually constrain our imaginative capacities.

Two explanations: - Impossibility Hypothesis - inability to imagine impossibilities - Unwillingness Hypothesis - We are unwilling to allow ourselves to i-believe morally dubious claims

Both theories involve non-epistemic constraints - Do not concern the truth value of the claims in question

But we might ask "what is a fictional truth value?"

Consider epistemic norms: - Norms - Background beliefs

Consistency, here, beliefs must be consistent with each other. But perhaps a better term here is relevance (Lewis 1982). What we would be looking for then is a "relevant implication" that preserves truth.

Truth norms include: what I believe is true. These are determined by testing them against claims that I already know. However, a claim like "the sky is blue" is only true when spoken in the context of persons who possess the faculty of sight. This might then make such claims context-sensitive. It may be that our changing contexts then can lead to changes in our i-beliefs about the fiction. It is also possible that another aspect of context includes questions of genre. But perhaps these are more controversial. 2. genre-sensitive 1. whether the object is fiction or myth changes my acceptance 3. differs from person to person 3. Social Norms 1. Contributes sensitivity to background i-beliefs